



WESTERN BALKANS FUND

THIRD CONFERENCE OF THE MINISTERS OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS

JOINT STATEMENT

(Warsaw, 12 April 2019)

The Western Balkans Fund Conference of Ministers of Foreign Affairs (WBF CMFA), meeting in Warsaw, Republic of Poland, on 12 April 2019:

Highlighting the joint commitment to the principles of regional ownership and all-inclusiveness, as essential concepts for the successful and substantial implementation of regional cooperation agenda in the Western Balkans;

Noting with satisfaction that Western Balkans Fund, is accomplishing its core objectives: supporting human mobility, “soft connectivity” and strengthening people-to-people contacts in our region;

Underlining with appreciation the positive results of the implementation phase of the WBF Regional Projects of the First Call, as a clear sign of the readiness, maturity and willingness of our region to further cooperate and strengthen good neighbourly relations;

Considering very positively the high number of organizations involved as applicants and partners in the WBF Second Call, creating broad and vivid networks covering every angle of the region;

Appreciating the professional engagement of the WBF Secretariat throughout the process of the Second Call and for creating the preliminary list of the Winning Projects for each WBF Contracting Party;

Encouraging WBF Executive Director, WBF Secretariat and the WBF Committee of Senior Officials to carefully monitor the implementation of projects, as a direct contribution to the enhancement of people-to-people contacts in the region;

We have decided:

1. To approve the List of Winning Projects under WBF Second Call for Regional Projects, 2019.
2. Following the provisions of Article 39 of the WBF Statute, we encourage the WBF Council of Senior Officials following the completion of external audit report to come with concrete and consensual suggestions, for raising the Annual Contribution of the Contracting Parties to the WBF budget, aiming to extend and strengthen this genuine and extremely relevant initiative of ours;

We express our gratitude to the Minister Mr. Behgjet Pacolli, Chairman-in-Office of the WBF-2019 and to Polish Hosts, for the hospitality and excellent arrangements made for the Meeting.

Done in Warsaw, 12 April 2019